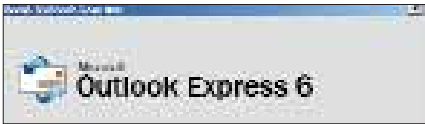


Outlook Express 6

If you have Windows installed on your machine, you are likely to have a version



of this e-mail client on your computer. Outlook Express has evolved from a faulty, buggy and insecure e-mail client to a slightly more stable but still quite bland client. But it remains an easy-to-use option.

It allows you to create folders and set basic filters and rules to them. It supports the NNTP protocol, making it easy to collaborate with newsgroups. The easy-to-use interface makes it a favourite with most desktop users. The integration with Microsoft's Hotmail service means that you can read your Hotmail messages within the client and store them offline if you like. With the latest release, Outlook Express has become more stable. However, it is more vulnerable to viruses than other clients due to its support for VBScript, which is on by default but can be turned off. Be ready to download and install patches any time Microsoft releases a new update, as this is one of the hottest exploits around.

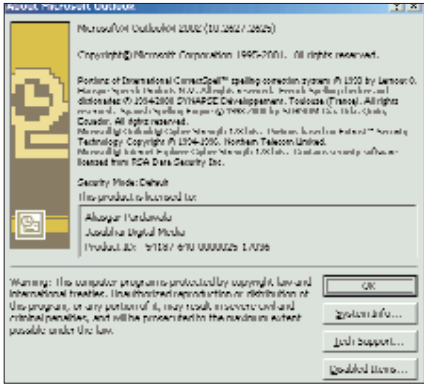
If you need multiple user support, Outlook Express is the best bet. It can handle multiple e-mail profiles and configure each to access various e-mail accounts. Each user profile can have customised settings, mail profiles, etc. The e-mail editor is also quite good. It provides all features right from formatting text to adding background colours. Support for basic templates is also a nice touch.

- + Very simple and easy-to-use interface
 - + Comprehensive feature set
 - Vulnerable to viruses
- Price:** Free for use (comes bundled with Internet Explorer)

Microsoft Outlook 2002

This e-mail client, part of the Microsoft Office Family, is also sold as a standalone program. It's a complete personal information manager which takes care of your mail, appointments and other daily schedules and reminders. You can automate actions linking two activities together, for example, planning a meeting and sending the schedule to the relevant people automatically.

When combined with an Exchange 2000 server in organisations, Outlook 2002 allows you to send notifications for meetings and appointments including task report notification to a whole group, maintained on the server side. You can set alarms to be reminded of pending tasks or appointments. This version does not have any



drastic improvement over the previous one, but the subtle changes make it a pleasure to work with. Features such as colour coding, group scheduling, improved integration of WinWord for editing/composing mails and implementation of task pane and voice capability make it a favourite amongst business class users.

What you Need in an E-mail Client

- **Interface:** Since e-mail is going to be a regular chore, it's best to use something that you are comfortable using.
- **Features:** Test the features that you will be using commonly, say an address book. If you have a wide base of contacts, you'll need multiple address books and perhaps a bulk-mailing feature.
- **Security:** If security is an issue, make sure the software comes with some form of built-in encryption such as PGP and MIME.
- **Customisation:** Taking care of multiple e-mail accounts can be rather painful; ensure that each user of your computer can segregate their settings from yours.
- **Protocol Support:** Essential for POP3 and IMAP4 in order to ensure universal access with various types of mail clients.

Top e-mail related downloads		
Plug-ins	Anti-virus and security	Spam filters
PureVoice Player-Recorder	PGP	SpamKiller
LifeFX FaceMail	Norton AntiVirus 2002	EMail Sentry
SMSReminder	AVG	AvirMail
VoiceNotify	F-Secure	Spam Buster

Microsoft has beefed up the security features and made this program quite resilient to viruses. It has also integrated MSN messenger service which was previously missing.

Overall, this program is an excellent Personal Information Manager—useful for executives who need help keeping track of their daily chores. To unlock its full potential (especially the collaboration features) you should use Outlook 2002 in a corporate work environment along with Exchange 2000.

- + Takes care of all the needs with respect to e-mailing and task scheduling
 - + Support for Exchange2000 server, integration with Office XP
 - + Extremely easy to operate
 - Requires Outlook Express to be installed
- Price:** Rs 5,000
Contact: Microsoft Corporation India P Ltd
Phone: 011-6294600
Fax: 011-6292650
E-mail: msconnect@microsoft.com

Netscape 6.2 (Messenger)

The new Composer can add numerous e-mail accounts and working is simpler. Like all e-mail clients, this one too allows you to add customised filters for messages, and the new version includes a set of templates for easy and quick replying. It doesn't support VB scripting. So it's not prone



to be infected with viruses that use VB script for

executing. Composer supports sharing of the e-mail folder for others to view. But here one must manually scroll to the mail folder and then share it. Like Outlook Express, it supports news servers and works well as a newsgroup client. Overall, this is a good e-mail client and desktop users not satisfied with Outlook Express (and it's security) will be safe with Composer.

- + Good sporty interface
 - + Does not support VB scripting
 - No support for plugins
- Price:** Free for use (comes with Netscape 6.2 browser)
Web site: <http://browsers.netscape.com/browsers/main.tmpl>

PRASHANT MASRANI